MAY 2025

STARTUP PLAYBOOKS REPORT

Built for founders, operators, and investors who care about execution over hype.

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Google Cloud

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Notion

FOR THE FIRST TIME EVER, FIND OUT THE REAL PLAYBOOKS DRIVING SUCCESS AT

Hnry

heidi

go1

nexl

AutoGrab

neara

kismet

Lorikeet

STARTUP PLAYBOOKS REPORT

TABLE OF CONTENTS

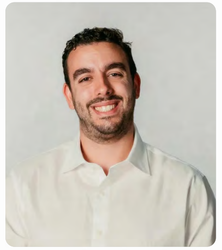
The High Flyers at the featured companies	04
5 lessons from the best startups	05
Hnry's playbook	06
Google Cloud case study	08
Heidi Health's playbook	09
Notion case study	11
Kismet's playbook	12
Nexl's playbook	14
Vanta case study	16
Neara's playbook	17
Go1's playbook	19
Lorikeet's playbook	21

THE HIGH FLYERS AT THE FEATURED STARTUPS

HIGH FLYERS THROUGH PERFORMANCE AND EXECUTION, NOT JUST TITLE

Remy Wheat
Head Of Operations, Lorikeet

Jesse Creighton
Commercial Lead (Usa), Heidi Health



Tom Kelly
Co-founder & Ceo, Heidi Health

Madi Shove
Svp, Marketing, Go1

Jj Refling
Strategic Ai Success, Lorikeet

Raghav Sharma
Commercial Lead (Uk), Heidi Health

Kristina Ryan
Vp, Product & Design, Go1

Jack Curtis
Chief Commercial Officer @ Neara

Albert Patajo,
Chief Of Staff, Nexl

Brandon Palmer
Head Of Marketing, Hnry

Karan Anand
Managing Director (Australia), Hnry

Stewart Bird
Chief Product Officer, Autograb

Mark Woodland
Co-founder & Ceo, Kismet

Nat Mendel
Chief Of Staff @ Kismet

5 LESSONS FROM THE FIELD:

WHAT THE BEST STARTUPS ARE DOING DIFFERENTLY.

01

Execution Over Hype

The most successful startups don't chase trends—they obsess over fast, focused execution.

Example: Hnry

Started with a $10K test to prove ROAS. Volume and iteration beat polished perfection. Performance built trust—brand came later, backed by data.

Hnry

02

Let the Market Pull You

True global expansion success happens when customer demand—not internal ambition—pulls you in.

Example: Heidi Health

US and UK success came from organic traction—PLG, GP advocacy, and emotional resonance. They followed momentum, not a master plan.

heidi

03

Structure Over Speed in Enterprise Sales

Don't try to hack long sales cycles—design for discipline and efficiency instead.

Example: Neara

Neara built a deal framework to qualify leads fast, fire bad fits, and focus the team on winnable deals. Progress is tracked weekly, with tight internal alignment across every sales stage.

neara

04

Acquisition as a GTM Playbook

Acquisitions aren't just for scale—they can be the strategy itself.

Example: Kismet

Built a $50M+ ARR business with no marketing team. Growth comes from values-aligned acquisitions, customer trust, and post-sale relationship building.

kismet

05

Operational Excellence Wins

Hiring, rituals, and structure are the real growth accelerators—especially across borders.

Examples: Go1 & Lorikeet

Go1 promotes internally to preserve speed and context. Lorikeet hired senior operators early and built async-first systems to scale across time zones without friction.

go1 Lorikeet

Hnry

HNRY'S MARKETING EVOLUTION:

FROM ROI CHAMPION TO BRAND INNOVATOR

How we built New Zealand's largest tax agency, became Australia's fastest growing, and raised $60M—one creative at a time.

Performance as Necessity

Early stage, low budget, high ROAS focus to prove value

The $10K Test: Trust through ROAS

- Every dollar had to return revenue—ROAS was our North Star.
- Started with $10K instead of $20K to prove marketing's impact.
- Built trust early with the founders by focusing on high-value conversions.
- No room for brand until we earned the right.

Creative at Scale

Volume over quality, rapid iteration to outpace competition

Outpacing the Competition through Volume

- Discovered creative volume > individual brilliance.
- Ad platforms reward iteration and speed over polish.
- Example: low-expectation ad returned 10x ROI over time.
- Fast internal cycles (brief to shoot in <1 week) outpaced incumbents.

Disrupting the Taste Makers

Data-led brand building, Soul Trader campaign success

Brand Built on Data, Not Opinions

- Challenge to the "Mad Men" model—no subjective exec decisions.
- We test creative cheaply, promote proven winners to brand channels.
- Example: Soul Trader ad started as a TikTok test → became national brand platform.
- $50K total spend for TV-ready campaign with full confidence.

WHAT DOES THIS ACTUALLY LOOK LIKE IN PRACTISE FOR HNRY?

Hnry

The $10K Challenge

> "I was given $20K per month to spend on marketing. I spent $10K instead—to prove it would work."

- As the sole marketing resource, the goal was simple: build trust through performance.
- Started with half the allocated budget to prove out ROAS and earn internal credibility.
- Every conversion was tracked, not just for volume but quality—chasing high-value signups with high lifetime value.
- Built a reputation for marketing as a revenue-driving function, not a cost centre.
- The question I wanted to hear was "with this level of performance, why aren't we spending more money?"

Insight "We weren't just chasing sign-ups—we were chasing the right sign-ups."

The Unexpected Creative Performer

> "We didn't even like it. But we ran it anyway—and it quietly became a 10x ROI performer."

- When you're focussed on volume, you don't get it right every time - as a marketer, you need to come to terms with that.
- One ad in particular didn't test well internally and nearly got scrapped.
- We decided to put it onto the ad platforms anyway to recoup production cost.
- To my surprise, it ended up consistently converting, sitting in the funnel longer than expected.
- Highlighted the real learning: volume + speed > creative perfection.
- Ad platforms thrive on volume. The more creative in your funnel, the more efficient they can be.
- We've had to plead with the ad platforms over the years to allow us more space of ad inventory.

Insight "Even the duds help the machine work better."

Brand Grows from Performance

> "Most brands are built on opinion. We build ours on proof."

- Traditional brand marketing relies on creative directors and subjective calls - this is called "taste-making," and it's dominated the marketing industry for 80 years.
- Hnry's approach is disrupting this outdated model. We run small-spend performance tests with multiple creatives and lets the audience decide.
- The best-performing creatives are then promoted to brand channels like TV, BVOD, and YouTube - supported with OOH spend.
- Eliminates risk of spending millions on a campaign that doesn't land.
- When we put millions of dollars of spend behind an ad, we already know that it resonates with our target audience and converts them into customers.

Soul Trader example:

- Started as a quick $20K TikTok shoot—fun, unpolished, high-performing.
- Promoted to national campaign with an extra $30K production expense to adapt for TV/BVOD.
- Became the brand platform for the year.

Insight "We don't guess which ad will work. We let the audience decide"

Google Cloud

SPONSOR FEATURE

HOW AUTOGRAB USES GOOGLE CLOUD TO POWER GLOBAL GROWTH

AutoGrab

Building from a Solid Data Foundation to expand to NZ, Malaysia, UK and EU:

Beachhead Focus
Started with solving car-buying for dealerships

Data as a Moat
Trained pricing models using structured market data

Product Expansion
Grew across dealership lifecycle & F&I

360° Profile
Merged company, vehicle & market data

75% YoY growth

500% DAU growth

1000% increase in vehicle records

3000% increase in API usage

" Data underpins everything we do. By starting with a focused beachhead and methodically expanding into lifecycle and market insights, we built an unparalleled data foundation. We've been deliberate in enriching it with every product we launch. That's been our edge—and with Google's support in structuring, scaling and regionalising our infrastructure, we've been able to move faster into AI-driven growth than we ever imagined"

Stewart Bird, Chief Product Officer, AutoGrab

Powering Innovation with Google Cloud

Cloud Infrastructure

Scalable, serverless data warehousing with BigQuery powers our real-time analytics and complex joins across disparate datasets. Cloud Storage provides cost-effective storage for raw and processed data

Global Expansion

Google Cloud's global regions, multi-region services (like BigQuery datasets and Cloud CDN for faster insight delivery), and expertise smoothed our path into new markets while meeting local data compliance needs.

AI Enablement

Vertex AI provided a unified platform for ML model development and deployment. Early access to Gemini models via Vertex AI Studio & the API, along with technical support from Google Cloud teams, helped fast-track our first generative AI offerings for tasks like market summarisation or strategy generation.

HEIDI HEALTH

EXPANSION PLAYBOOK – AUSTRALIA TO US & UK

How we expanded beyond Australia and into the UK and the US, with 10,000s of users in each market now

US EXPANSION

- **Go Moment**
  No single trigger. Early CACs in US via Meta looked promising. Building user led customisation closed the imagination gap. Allowed others to recognise themselves and see their needs served. Competitors didn't have the moat they (or Heidi) thought they did.
- **Initial Wedge**
  State of Indiana worked as a test → high-touch Customer Success → word of mouth network effect with GP clinics. This was an example of doing things that don't scale and yielding results.
- **GTM Motion**
  Individual SMB Clinics Mid-Market
- **What Worked**
  Over-invested early, Aussie-style sales felt authentic
- **Mistakes**
  Delayed EHR integration, skipped enterprise PR too long

UK EXPANSION

- **Go Moment**
  Advisor said 'don't go'. Early GP love told us otherwise.
- **Initial Wedge**
  Book-a-demo users confirmed the initial customer interest. No particular localisation was needed because Australia was highly referenceable as their home market.
- **Tipping Point**
  Deeply weaving safety and compliance into the narrative alongside product capability.
- **GTM Motion**
  PLG GP-led Enterprise champions
- **What Worked**
  Early GTM: PLG + live demo gating + grassroots evangelists, especially GPs.
- **What Didn't**
  Early hiring missteps, finding generalists with grit

Product x AI Playbook

AI Utility

We established product-market fit, confirming that our Scribe product delivered immediate out-of-the-box value across both Australian and international markets

Compliance to drive growth

Overcome concerns with deep local understanding

Activation Consistency

Same onboarding UX worked in the UK and US, thanks to customer pain points replication from Australia

GTM Acceleration

PLG surfaced users -> Heidi sales team onboarded clinicians -> Product delight

IF WE DID IT AGAIN

What we did

- Hired 1 person in the UK
- Deprioritised EHRs
- Chased Launch Partners

What we would do if we had our time again

- Hired 2 doers to get accurate performance and market signals
- Embrace reality early
- Built leverage for partners to want to work with us

HEIDI HEALTH EXPANSION: US VS UK

What does this actually look like in practise?

Trigger to Enter

US (Jesse-led)

No formal "go" decision. PLG showed traction in US via paid ads.

"There was never anything that necessarily happened that indicated, 'Okay, it's time for the US.' It was just a function of what the product was."

UK (Rags-led)

"If we listened to what some of our advisors told us, it'd just be like, forget about it... But the clinician love was stronger than any other market."

Early Wedge

US (Jesse-led)

Indiana clinic: small win → over-support → regional virality.

"We threw the kitchen sink at them... flew out, visited them every other week."

UK (Rags-led)

GP clinics & private consultants. Gated demos revealed emotional demand.

"It was like they felt they had to deserve a 30-minute call."

Go-to-Market Motion

US (Jesse-led)

PLG (individual) → SMB → Mid-market / Enterprise (reactive).

"It just happened naturally... it was growing so fast that we often said "Oh crap, we need a team feature."

UK (Rags-led)

PLG in GP space, evangelist-led growth in enterprise.

"In primary care, one GP is connected to 15 others... That motion accrued super quickly."

Key Mistakes

US (Jesse-led)

Avoided EHR integration out of idealism. Under-invested in enterprise brand early.

"We didn't want to be tethered to the systems... but at some point, you've got to suck it up and play within the rules."

UK (Rags-led)

Chose wrong first hire. Bet on partner-led GTM too early.

"We approached BT, Accenture, KPMG... It never worked. We had no leverage."

Going global but not starting from zero

Australia's healthcare system (private & public) is highly referenceable, with similar customer pain points across markets, making replication easier.

The main product funnel has to work in every region - a key question was "Will our users use their product in the same way in the UK and the US, like in Australia?"

Notion

notion.com/startups

SPONSOR FEATURE

HOW STARTUPS USE NOTION FROM IDEA TO IPO

IDEA

Idea Generation
Business model Canvas
Brainstorming
Industry Analysis

LAUNCH

Company Website
PR & Media Tracker
Product Launch Guide
Terms & Privacy

FUNDRAISE

Investor CRM
Investor Dataroom
Pitch Deck
Investor Updates

SCALE

Company metrics
Company Goals/OKRs
Company Home/Wiki
Product Roadmap

Twine: Building Fast, Staying Aligned with Notion

Twine runs nearly everything in Notion—from product strategy to investor updates and even their internal meme board. Highlights:

- Investor updates via a reusable Notion template
- Blog, changelog, and brand assets managed in Notion databases
- Early sales and feedback handled through shared Notion pages
- Web content drafted in Notion before moving to Figma.

Twine

Qwilr: Boosting Collaboration and Productivity

Qwilr, an Australian software company specializing in proposals, uses Notion as the backbone of their operations. The results speak for themselves:

- Reduced search time for information by 30%
- Consolidation of documents and workflows, driving operational efficiency
- Streamlined management of product roadmaps and internal documentation.

Qwilr

Linktree: Scaling with Efficiency

Linktree, a platform that connects over 30 million users to their content, has adopted Notion to support rapid business growth. With Notion, Linktree has:

- Aligned teams across product development, marketing, and customer success
- Reduced redundant tools, saving hours of weekly coordination time
- Fostered seamless communication across their global workforce

Linktree

SCALING WITH PURPOSE

KISMET'S GO-TO-MARKET STRATEGY FOR ACQUISITIONS

The Acquisition Formula, Case Study, and Lessons from a 35-Person Team Redefining Growth in Healthcare

Kismet is transforming the healthcare and disability support sector by streamlining access to essential services and optimising operational efficiency with AI and automation. With just 35 people, they've built a highly disciplined, tech-enabled care platform. Their team operates like an elite special forces unit: small, skilled, and relentlessly focused on excellence. Inspired by the principles of "Unreasonable Hospitality", Kismet are dedicated to creating exceptional experiences for their customers, building lasting relationships, and leaving an unforgettable impact.

Unpacking the Acquisition Formula

Kismet doesn't buy software - they acquire revenue, relationships, and trust. They lead with Unreasonable Hospitality, approaching every acquisition with care, integrity, and respect. It's more than a deal - it's a lasting partnership built on shared values and mutual success.

FIND

- Warm referrals, brokers, and outbound approach
- Understand seller intent, business model and growth

QUALIFY, PRICE & SET TERMS

- Due diligence on participants, compliance, community reputation and values alignment
- Refined pricing model: pay-per-participant

MIGRATE

- Tech migration led by Kismet
- Seamless handover of software to ensure no payment delays
- Data + system access secured early

DELIGHT & RETAIN

- "Unreasonable Hospitality" model - proactive, personalised support and exceeding expectations at every touch-point
- CX team builds emotional loyalty through real connections

How does this unlock growth for Kismet?

When Kismet acquires businesses, they:

- Capture revenue before close
- Retain nearly all participants
- Maintain relationships and build trust with community leaders
- Migrate systems with no downtime
- Strengthen brand reputation through their Unreasonable Hospitality approach to healthcare and customer service

The Anti-Startup Model Driving Growth

- No BDMs, SDRs, or marketing team to drive growth
- Flat structure: everyone reports to execs
- Technology enables scale without headcount
- "Unreasonable Hospitality" is not a feature, it's the strategy
- Everyone feels understood, valued, and supported

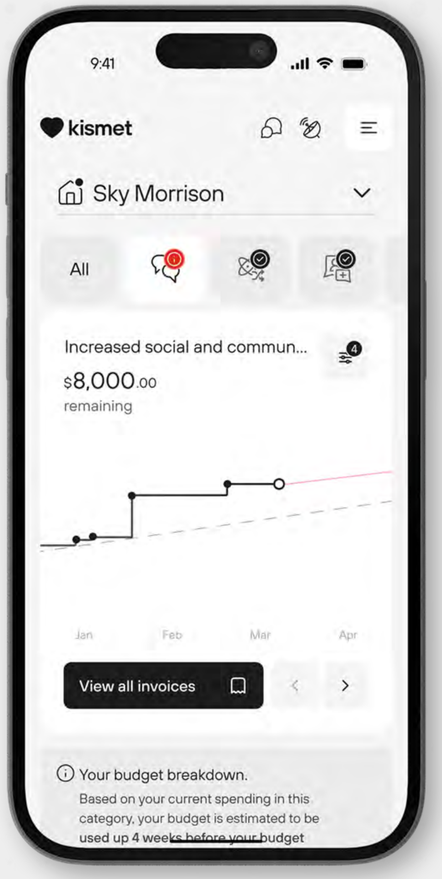
kismet

Real world examples

The Multiplier Effect - Matt Trezise sold his Plan Management to Kismet, joined the team, helped onboard his own customers, and now uses his network to find high-quality sellers. He is also heavily involved in the post- customers acquisition integration phase. Having been through it, he is able to help through this change and ensure seamless transitions.

> "After running my Plan Management business for 3.5 years, the pressure of new government regulations became overwhelming. Exploring my options, I met Sam from Kismet, and immediately felt a genuine connection. Unlike other buyers, Kismet's warm approach made me feel supported. I sold my business to Kismet and planned to stay briefly, but over a year later, I'm still here.
>
> Now, I'm helping other Plan Management owners navigate the same uncertainties I faced, and it's incredibly rewarding. Kismet's honesty and values align with my own, and I'm proud to be part of a team that lets me work hard, help others, and stay true to my principles."
>
> **Matt Trezise**

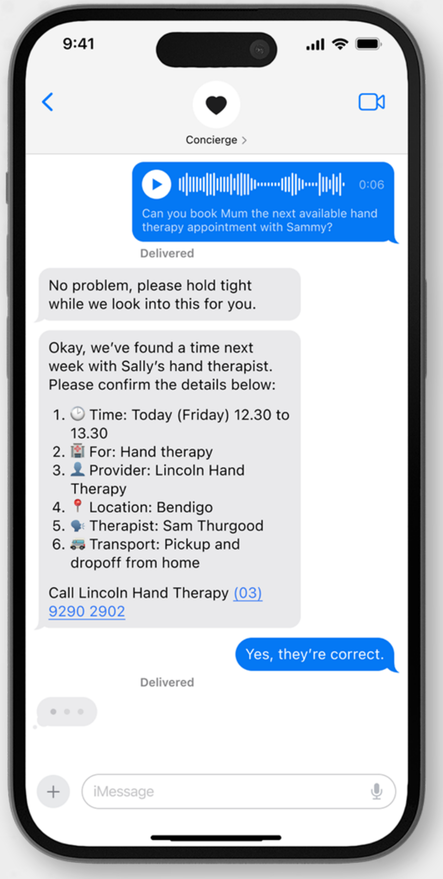
> "Selling our Plan Management business, So Joe, to Kismet wasn't just a business decision—it was the moment I realised that letting go could unlock something far greater. Kismet didn't just take over our vision; they elevated it, integrating our strengths into their systems and showing how letting go can lead to growth and new possibilities. With the right partner, the vision we built didn't fade; it flourished, transforming into a powerful force for change that exceeded anything I could have imagined."
>
> **Zoe Cluff**



Kismet's Budget Tool - a way for people to track their spend against allocated budgets.

Our app helps care receivers in Australia to create or upload their care or insurance plan. It automatically identifies available budget within their insurance schemes, including government schemes.

Conversational Healthcare to be released - Powered by your favourite messaging app you can just type or speak your request.



How Nexl has executed on M&A to expand globally

Structuring an Acquisition:
How to Choose the Right Transaction Structure

Criteria	Acqui-Hire	Asset Purchase	Share Purchase
Description	Acquire people/talent from the target via employment offers. Ideal when there is a strong team. Leverage IP assignments to acquire IP.	Acquire selected assets (i.e. IP, customer contracts) and assume specific liabilities.	Acquire the target's entire company by purchasing shares.
Complexity	Low	Medium	High
Size of Acquisition	Small Acquisitions (1-10 FTE),	Small to Medium Size Acquisitions (5— 50+FTE),	Medium to large (50+ FTE),
Traction of Target	Limited traction / customer contracts (pre-revenue),	Revenue generating with some valuable customer contracts.	Significant revenue and customer traction.
Benefits of Structure	Acqui-hires can be executed quickly with limited transaction documents required. This structures avoids historical liabilities associated with the target.	This structure enables you to pick and choose the assets in an acquisition, leaving liabilities with the target's entity.	Share purchases are a clean transfer of operations and ownership and can be lower complexity than an asset sale if there's significant contracts associated with the target.
Challenges & Considerations	Need to ensure cultural and values alignment with your existing team.	Operational disruption due to the integration required to migrate customer contracts. Requires significant legal documentation.	Significant operational disruption and back-office integration required to ensure value is retained and transferred. Acquirer inherits all liabilities.
Best When	The talent is the primary driver for long-term value creation.	You want only parts of the target (i.e. assets) and want to avoid liabilities.	You want seamless continuity and operational handover for customers and employees.

You can structure most startup acquisitions with these two approaches and use a combination of upfront cash, equity, earn-outs, etc to get creative with costs.

Proactive vs: Reactive M&A:
How to Build a Corporate Development Function

1. Proactive M&A (Programmatic M&A)

What is it?
Programmatic M&A is a repeatable acquisition strategy focused on building long-term capabilities or market position through a series of smaller, strategic deals. It is intentional, strategic and systematic.

What is needed?
Companies need a dedicated corporate development function who can work with the management team, product team and Board to draft the long-term vision, M&A teams and capabilities gap. This function will be responsible for proactive sourcing, target lists, relationship building, standardising diligence and integration and managing the transaction.

1. Thesis Development → 2. Deal Sourcing & Selection → 3. Diligence & Transaction Structuring → 4. Board Approval → 5. Integration

2. Reactive M&A (Opportunistic M&A)

What is it?
Reactive deal-making driven by attractive, one-off opportunities that arise — such as distressed sales, inbound interest, or sudden market shifts. It is one-off, timing-driven and reactive.

What is needed?
Companies need flexible and fast decision making and the ability to rapidly diligence a target and build conviction around the opportunity. You will need to communicate quickly with your Board and investors and have access to capital or cash reserves.

1. Inbound Opportunity → 2. Rapid Diligence → 3. Deal Structuring → 4. Board Approval → 5. Integration

Nexl's specific learnings from their M&A journey

At Nexl, we have done multiple acquisitions using different deal structures and we have done diligence on many more. Here are our top learnings as we moved through our M&A journey.

1. Engage your Board Early, and Often

Build trust with your Board through regular updates, transparency of materials and process.

During our acquisitions, we had regular meetings and ad-hoc phone calls to keep our Board updated on progress. We also conscripted several of our investors to help with.

2. Align Expectations with Leadership

Communicate the implications of the acquisition with your leadership team.

We make sure to write robust communication plans with timelines and who should be notified and in which order. This meant that we could align messaging consistently across the company.

3. Get Your People Excited

Your team won't get excited unless you are. Start with the market opportunity and what this acquisitions enable you to achieve and then articulate the "why" in a way that resonates.

We announce acquisitions at our all-company meetings and get the team a virtual stage to introduce themselves and what they're excited about. This gets everyone at Nexl excited too!

4. Write a Clear Thesis and Value Creation Plan

Your value creation plan needs to be specific, measurable, and owned. Outline what needs to be true and what needs to go right to unlock this value and ensures clear workstreams, deliverables and accountability processes.

We present a clear thesis to the Board as part of our acquisition process. This always has NPV/ROI analysis and product roadmap considerations.

5. Define Success and Create a Scorecard

Creating a scorecard for success shows you know what you're doing and can guide your activities post-close.

We create KPIs for success that we track to ensure we're creating value from our acquisitions. This helps us prove and validate our thesis.

6. Don't Fall in Love with the Deal

Most acquisitions aren't value accretive. Be clear about how much you're willing to pay and how much investment is required for a successful integration. Don't overpay for a deal, it's okay to walk away when the price isn't right.

We make sure to quickly set price expectations internally and we walk away when the price isn't aligned to the acquisitor thesis.

"As a startup, you have to be disciplined about your thesis, definition of success, transaction structure and price because access to capital can be limited. Raising capital to fund a transaction can be dilutive, especially when the acquisition isn't value accretive in the long term.

There's lots of creative ways you can structure an acquisition depending on the thesis underpinning an acquisition. If you're after customers and it's a bulk-up transaction, consider structuring a deal as asset purchase on a CAC-basis with earn-outs based on retention. If you're after IP, consider the cost of building it internally and backwards solve for price based on this and the market opportunity you can accelerate. If you're leveraging an acqui-hire approach, use your current ESOP to offset differences in salary."

Albert Patajo
Chief of Staff, Nexl

SPONSOR FEATURE

How Everlab cuts compliance costs by 50% with Vanta

ACCELERATED CERTIFICATION

Venta's automation, templates, and onboarding support helped Everlab fast-track its27001 process with minimal lift

SAVINGS THAT SCALE

Choosing Vantra over a manual approach cut costs by over 50% - savings tens of thousands in time and resources.

BUILT FOR GROWTH

With a scalable compliance framework in place, Everlab is ready to expand into new markets and obtain future standards.

The Challenge
Scaling Trust with Growth

As Everlab expanded its team and partnerships, trust became critical—especially around sensitive healthcare data. Without ISO 27001 certification, enterprise sales were slower. Manual compliance was a painful, unsustainable option.

As Everlab co-founder Anshul Jain points out, "When it comes to healthcare data, one of the first questions people ask is 'What's your security like?'"

The Solution
Automated Compliance with Vanta

Everlab partnered with Vanta to fast-track ISO 27001 using time-saving automation, seamless integrations, and expert guidance. The setup was smooth, with templated policies and a structured 30-day onboarding program.

This made the process even smoother than expected, with Anshul noting that "everything just worked out of the box."

The Impact
Faster Sales, Scalable Trust

Certification (and the journey toward it) has built instant credibility with partners, while automation saved nearly 50% in internal costs. Vanta has also laid the foundation for future frameworks like HIPAA and SOC 2.

"It's helped enforce security discipline across the organisation."

"If we'd done everything manually, it would have cost us up to AUD$100k in time and resources. Partnering with Vanta has cut that by more than half."
Anshul Jain, Co-Founder, Everlab

neara

Neara's Formula for Optimising, Not Accelerating, the Long Sales Cycle

"At Neara, we don't aim to shorten the enterprise sales cycle — we design systems to maximise win rates and minimise time waste."

"In enterprise sales, the discipline of firing leads is as important as the discipline involved in moving leads forward." **— Jack Curtis, Chief Commercial Officer**

SYSTEM DESIGN

How Neara Systematised Sales Execution

ICP Identification
Week 1-2

Enterprise size
Industry vertical
Tech maturity level
Growth trajectory

Qualification
Week 3-5

Budget authority
Decision timeframe
Stakeholder access
Problem urgency

Solution Development
Week 6-10

Technical fit
ROI modeling
Implementation plan
Success metrics

WEEKLY RHYTHM

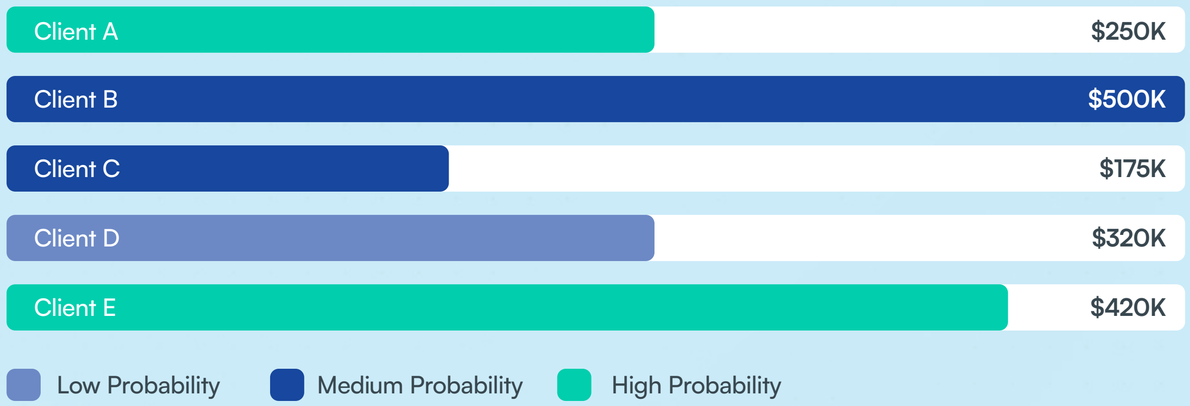
Operational Cadence for Discipline

- Weekly reviews by stage/timing
- Progress targets for each deal
- Prune underperforming deals

FORECASTING

Pipeline by Probability

Objective Pipeline stages drive monthly forecast regeneration



neara

Do's and Don'ts for Sales Success, directly from Neara's Chief Commercial Officer's Lived Experience.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR IN ENTERPRISE SALES HIRES

DO'S

- Experience selling similar ACVs
- Competitive athletic background
- System-oriented approach
- Technical aptitude and curiosity

DON'TS

- Overreliance on personal rolodex
- Big company pedigree only
- Pure relationship sellers
- Purely individual performers

QUALIFYING FOR NEED, TIMING, AND INFLUENCE

DO'S

- Focus on P&L owners
- Validate budget authority early
- Map decision-making process
- Establish success metrics upfront

DON'TS

- Ignore timeframe signals
- Get stuck with innovation teams only
- Overinvest in unqualified leads
- Rush to technical demos

Build community, don't sell | Invest in brand/content | Measure what matters (3 metrics max)

STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT: DO'S & DON'TS

DO'S

- Orchestrate multi-stakeholder engagement — you can never have too many engaged stakeholders in enterprise sales
- Engage 2nd/3rd order influencers (consultants, advisors, service providers, etc.), not just the direct customer
- Figure out what sits upstream from your solution (e.g. data, field implementation), even if you're not delivering it

DON'TS

- Assume one point of engagement is enough — always presume otherwise
- Assume non-trivial change management or process change isn't required for adoption — proactively support customer through it
- Assume 'services' is a dirty word — unless the customer will drive adoption/validation themselves, offer your own services team

MARKETING THAT FUELS ENTERPRISE SALES

> "If I had $10,000 to spend on one marketing initiative, I would spend it on a well curated, theme focused customer event. Create a community with your customers — i.e. customer advisory boards, tailored customer events focused on problems they care about. Don't use these forums to sell, use them to build trust and credibility."
>
> **Jack Curtis, Chief Commercial Officer**

Go1's Playbook: Building Culture, Leadership & Excellence

Go1 approaches promoting from within as a strategic lever to maintain cultural integrity while driving operational and commercial scale. Their decision-making process is guided by context, phase-fit leadership capabilities, all while carefully balancing these internal promotions with strategic external hires.

PRODUCT & DESIGN
Kristina Ryan, VP

DESIGNING FOR SPEED, NOT COMPROMISE

Internal promotions that preserved momentum

When Go1 needed a new Head of Design, they looked internally—preserving critical product context and maintaining velocity during a high-growth phase.

Key Benefits:

- Fast ramp-up time (days vs. months)
- Deep product context and customer understanding
- Pre-established trust with cross-functional teams

MARKETING
Madi Shove, SVP

CONTEXT WINS, UNTIL IT DOESN'T

Product Marketing vs Growth Marketing

Go1's Product Marketing was built internally, leveraging deep product knowledge. For Growth Marketing, external expertise was needed to bring specialized skillsets.

SMB Launch Success:

The successful SMB product launch was directly attributed to a context-rich PMM team who understood both product nuances and market needs, shortening the time to market by 35%.

PROMOTE VS HIRE EXTERNAL: DECISION MATRIX

When to Promote Internally:

- When context is king (complex product/market)
- Cultural continuity is critical
- Speed is essential to capture market opportunity

When to Hire Externally:

- Skill set doesn't exist internally
- Fresh perspective needed to break patterns
- Entering new market/segment requires specialized expertise

Scaling with Intent: Remote, Mobility & Market Nuance

go1

Matching Talent to Business Phase

Product Evolution

From feature-building to outcome-driving

- Roadmap process evolved from backlog-driven to outcome-focused OKRs
- Planning horizon extended from 2 weeks to quarterly with annual vision
- Leadership role shifted from coordinating to enabling cross-functional autonomy

Marketing Transformation

From inbound-heavy to outbound-led

- Created specialized inbound and outbound pods with clear KPIs
- Developed segment-specific campaigns based on buying motions
- Shifted metrics from MQLs to pipeline influence and velocity

Remote Execution

Product Remote Strategy

- **Time Zone Consolidation**
  Teams grouped by ±3 hours for daily sync
- **Structured Reviews**
  Asynchronous reviews before live discussions
- **Monthly Written Updates**
  Comprehensive written docs shared before meetings to maximize discussion time

Marketing Remote Strategy

- **Geographic Strategy**
  Region-aligned teams for market fit
- **GPT Tools**
  AI for messaging consistency
- **Design Templates**
  Self-service creative assets

Structure + Tooling = Speed & Clarity

Standardized processes eliminate time zone friction

Acquisitions & Internal Mobility

Internal Mobility

Brand Marketing Leadership Story

When a high-performing marketer was at risk of leaving due to limited growth, Go1 expanded their role from narrow brand focus to leading integrated campaigns—resulting in 40% higher team output and retention of a key performer.

Key Lesson:

"Listen for signals of ambition before they become resignation letters. Internal mobility isn't just about retention—it's about unlocking latent capabilities."

Post-Acquisition Integration

What Worked

- Clear decision on operating model (eg. full integration or independent business unit);
- Acquisition thesis based on acceleration of go-to-market into new region; and
- Clear (and uncompromising) product principles.

What Didn't Work

- Blending of materially different organisation cultures without strict 'non-negotiables'
- Timezone complexity is real and amplifies perceived areas of misalignment (even if not major).

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Lorikeet

Scaling Globally from Day One

Unpacking Lorikeet's intentional approach

Australia + USA

Expanding from Sydney into the US accelerated operational maturity while enabling stronger customer relationships.

- Lorikeet started selling into global markets from its HQ in Sydney, Australia but realized the need for an on-the-ground presence in the US to build trust and manage complex relationships.
- Scaling across geos added operational complexity, in turn accelerating operational maturity, which created greater intentionality in determining how the company needed to work.
- US customers expect rapid innovation and are quick to adopt new AI solutions, providing valuable learning opportunities.

Approach to early hires

Intentionally hired experienced people with strong leadership and hands on skills, to build teams around.

- Focused on hiring experienced leaders and operators who could handle complexity and ambiguity and who craved the opportunity to do the actual work.
- The first two US hires fit this mould: JJ (ex-Stripe) and Remy (ex-Canva), brought on to lead and scale customer implementation and company operations, respectively.
- They were crucial in proactively addressing operational complexity, helping navigate time zone challenges effectively.

Excelling operationally

Ensured that the perspective of remote teammates is strongly represented in evolving how Lorikeet works.

- Used lightweight frameworks to maintain alignment while scaling the team and global footprint.
- Established (flexible) rituals and process early, to ensure scalability and maintain a high-quality customer experience.
- Defined clear ownership and encouraged autonomy to unblock decisions as the team expanded into different timezones with limited overlap for synchronous communication.
- Implemented a time zone-aware operating cadence, prioritizing effective asynchronous communication (e.g., Monday "standups" in Slack) and overlap hours for activities synchronous communication is high leverage (e.g., weekly All-Hands) to maintain clarity and momentum without burnout or delays.

Exactly how Lorikeet Invests in Hiring, AI, and Customer Implementation

Lorikeet

The value of work trials

- We prioritize transparency and authenticity in hiring.
- Instead of traditional interviews, we offer 2-day work trials.
- Trials help identify a candidate's strengths and ideal role fit.
- Candidates get a clear, firsthand view of the company and team.
- Trials provide a realistic preview of working at Lorikeet.
- Feedback from both the team and candidate informs final decisions.

AI gives us superpowers

- AI is central to everything we do at Lorikeet.
- We screen for curiosity in AI during the hiring process.
- Teammates are encouraged to ask, "Could I do this better/faster with AI?"
- Tools like Replit and ChatGPT empower non-technical teams to build tools and reports without engineering support.
- AI helps parse large data sets and forecast account team demands.
- We use AI to generate first drafts of weekly customer account health reports by extracting context from Slack, Linear, and past updates.

Customer Implementation vs. Success

- We hire AI Implementation Strategists instead of traditional customer success roles.
- Strategists have experience rolling out AI for customer support.
- Most customers are new to AI, so they value a trusted advisor throughout implementation.
- Our Strategists and Forward Deployed AI Engineers help define business goals and stay engaged to ensure success.
- We only charge for successfully resolved tickets—customers pay only for performance.
- This model aligns our success directly with our customers' success.

"Customer support is incredibly important to Magic Eden. We were very impressed with the CSAT scores Lorikeet delivered, but we also highly valued Lorikeet being a thought partner on helping us take our customer support to the next level."

- Daniel Cavagnino, Operations Manager, Magic Eden

"We're delivering faster, more efficient support to our patients like never before, with no compromise to patient experience. Improving first response time from 20 hours to 90 seconds has been transformational."

Omar Alvi, Managing Director, Pilot & Juniper

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